

Pregnancy

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Warm-Up

A. Checklist

Which medical care providers are you familiar with?

- | | |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------|
| _____ family doctor | _____ anesthesiologist |
| _____ obstetrician | _____ labor and delivery nurse |
| _____ midwife | _____ neonatal nurse |
| _____ ultrasound technician | _____ lactation consultant |

B. Discussion

Discuss the following questions in groups.

1. What symptoms are associated with early pregnancy?
2. What do women do if they suspect they are pregnant?
3. What stages is a pregnancy divided into?
4. What types of medical appointments do pregnant women need to have?
5. In your region, what options do women have for delivering their babies?
6. What complications can happen during a pregnancy?
7. What major questions do pregnant women often have for their health-care providers?
8. What is a birth plan?
9. What preparations do expecting parents need to make?
10. How does having a baby in this country compare to having one in other countries? Share your knowledge.

Warm-Up cont.

C. Vocabulary Preview

Word	Definition	Got it! (✓)
amniocentesis	a screening for abnormalities in the fetus (tests the amniotic fluid)	
amniotic sac	the sac containing fluid that protects the fetus in the womb	
anesthetic	a drug that temporarily prevents feeling in one area of the body	
birth canal	the parts of a woman's body where the fetus passes through during birth	
Braxton Hicks	false labor	
breech	a position where the baby's buttocks present first (not head first)	
Cesarian section	abdominal surgery to remove a baby from the uterus (C-section)	
cervix	the narrow, lower end of the uterus	
conception	the process of becoming pregnant (fertilization and implantation)	
contraction	the shortening of the uterine muscles before birth	
crown	to emerge headfirst (referring to the newborn's head during birth)	
dilate	to become more open	
due date	the estimated day a baby is expected to be born	
eclampsia	a dangerous condition related to high blood pressure during pregnancy	
embryo	the early stage of development before eight weeks of gestation	



Warm-Up cont.

C. Vocabulary Preview cont.

Word	Definition	Got it! (✓)
epidural	an anesthetic that removes feeling below the waist	
fetus	the stage of development after eight weeks of gestation and before birth	
folic acid	a vitamin necessary for the healthy development of a fetus	
forceps	an instrument used to help grasp an infant during a difficult delivery	
full-term	after 37 weeks of pregnancy	
gestation	the period of development in the womb	
gestational diabetes	high blood sugar levels during pregnancy	
gynecologist	a doctor who specializes in female reproduction	
in vitro fertilization	assisted fertilization that takes place outside the body (IVF)	
induce	to take actions that can get delayed labor started	
jaundiced	yellow in color due to levels of bilirubin	
labor	giving birth (the final stage of pregnancy)	
lactation	a mother's milk production and secretion	
midwife	a professional who assists a woman through pregnancy and childbirth	
miscarriage	the end of a pregnancy due to the natural death of an embryo or fetus	



Warm-Up cont.

C. Vocabulary Preview cont.

Word	Definition	Got it! (✓)
morning sickness	nausea experienced in the first few months of pregnancy	
neonatal	related to newborns	
NICU	the neonatal intensive care unit in a hospital (for premature or ill newborns)	
obstetrician	a doctor who specializes in women's reproduction and childbirth	
placenta	an organ in the uterus that provides oxygen and nutrients to the fetus	
postpartum/ postnatal	related to the period after childbirth	
premature	a birth before 37 weeks of gestation	
prenatal	related to the period before birth	
trimester	one of three stages of pregnancy (12–14 weeks)	
ultrasound	a scan that uses high-frequency sound waves to view inside the body	
umbilical cord	a cord that connects the embryo to the placenta	
uterus	the organ in the lower abdomen where the baby grows (the womb)	
water breaking	the release of amniotic fluid (usually shortly before or during labor)	

Types of Appointments

A. Reading

1. When a woman suspects she is pregnant, she can take a home pregnancy test. Early symptoms of pregnancy include a missed period, tender breasts, and fatigue. If a home pregnancy test confirms that the woman is pregnant, she can book an appointment with her family doctor to set up some prenatal visits and tests. If she doesn't have a family doctor, she can go to a walk-in clinic to get a referral.
2. Some pregnant women see their family doctor throughout their pregnancy. Others go to a specialist called an **obstetrician-gynecologist** (ob-gyn). These doctors specialize in caring for women during a pregnancy and delivering babies. Some women choose to use a **midwife** instead. A midwife is a trained professional who cares for a woman before, during, and after the delivery of a baby. A midwife can deliver a baby at home, at a birthing center, or at a hospital. Midwives also care for newborns. Unlike ob-gyns, midwives do not manage high-risk pregnancies or scheduled **Cesarian sections**.
3. After confirming a pregnancy, a doctor or midwife will schedule a follow-up appointment for an **ultrasound** screening. In the first **trimester**, a screening is used to confirm the expected due date. An ultrasound technician can listen for a heartbeat and determine if the woman is carrying a single baby or multiples (twins, triplets, etc.).
4. After 12 weeks of **gestation**, the chances of a **miscarriage** are less likely, and many women begin to show. In the second trimester, pregnant women are usually tested for **gestational diabetes**. This test involves drinking a very sweet drink and having a blood test. Some women also choose to have a test called an **amniocentesis** to check for genetic disorders. Other blood tests may also be used to monitor the mother's and baby's health.
5. During the third trimester, as pregnant women get closer to their **due date**, they visit their medical professional more regularly. The doctor or midwife will check the baby's growth, movement, and positioning. Further ultrasound screenings may or may not be needed.
6. When a pregnant woman goes into **labor**, she experiences **contractions**. The first contractions may be **Braxton Hicks** (false labor). Sometimes a woman's **water breaks**. As contractions get closer together, the woman notifies her provider that it's almost time for delivery, and they meet at the planned birthing location. Many pain management options are available. If the contraction pain is strong and the woman is at a hospital, she can request an **epidural**. If there are complications, the woman may need a C-section.
7. After the baby is delivered, the new mom may schedule some **postnatal** appointments, such as a visit with a family doctor or a **lactation** consultant.

Types of Appointments cont.

B. Comprehension

Practice asking and answering the following questions with your partner. Then write the answers in your notebook.

1. What type of medical professionals specialize in caring for pregnant women? Name two.
2. According to the reading, how are the two medical professionals from question 1 different? How are they the same?
3. What happens at an ultrasound screening during the first trimester?
4. What can a pregnant woman expect at a test for gestational diabetes?
5. What does a medical provider do at the third trimester checkup?
6. What does the term "Braxton Hicks" refer to?
7. What specific type of pain management is mentioned in the reading? Is this available at home births?
8. Who offers additional help to the mother and baby after the delivery?

C. Research

Answer Yes/No for each of the following statements based on the region you live in now. Then compare your answers with a partner. Look up any answers you aren't sure about.

- _____ 1. Midwives are available.
- _____ 2. Prenatal health care is provided by the government.
- _____ 3. Home births are legal.
- _____ 4. Pregnant women can find out the sex of their baby at an ultrasound screening.
- _____ 5. Pregnant women are tested for gestational diabetes in the second trimester.
- _____ 6. Amniocentesis is an optional test pregnant women can ask for.
- _____ 7. Epidurals are available at hospitals.
- _____ 8. A public health nurse makes a home visit after the baby goes home.

Vocabulary Review

A. Matching

Match the words and phrases on the left with the descriptions on the right.

- | | |
|-------------------------------|---|
| _____ 1. ob-gyn | a) With this temporary condition, you need to watch your sugar intake. |
| _____ 2. midwife | b) This optional procedure can identify genetic abnormalities that a screening might not catch. |
| _____ 3. ultrasound | c) This refers to all pregnancy stages from conception to birth. |
| _____ 4. trimester | d) This is the shortening of the uterine muscles during labor. |
| _____ 5. gestation | e) This specialist can care for you during a high-risk pregnancy and birth. |
| _____ 6. miscarriage | f) This allows a technician to see your baby in the womb. |
| _____ 7. gestational diabetes | g) This will reduce or prevent the feeling of pain during labor. |
| _____ 8. amniocentesis | h) She helps you give birth comfortably in your home or at the hospital. |
| _____ 9. due date | i) This is the loss of a baby that is not ready to leave the womb. |
| _____ 10. contraction | j) Each one lasts 12–14 weeks. |
| _____ 11. epidural | k) This is the approximate day your baby is due. |
| _____ 12. lactation | l) This is the production of milk so you can breastfeed your baby. |

B. Odd One Out

Circle the word that does not belong in each group of words below.
Be prepared to explain why.

- | | | | |
|--|--|---|--|
| 1. a) contractions
b) labor
c) due date | 4. a) epidural
b) anesthetic
c) gestation | 7. a) breast-feeding
b) lactation
c) diabetes | 10. a) gestation
b) lactation
c) development |
| 2. a) midwife
b) ob-gyn
c) ultrasound | 5. a) ultrasound
b) lactation
c) screening | 8. a) trimester
b) death
c) miscarriage | 11. a) relative
b) midwife
c) health-care worker |
| 3. a) optional
b) false labor
c) Braxton Hicks | 6. a) trimester
b) stage
c) due date | 9. a) doctor
b) ob-gyn
c) epidural | 12. a) amniocentesis
b) complication
c) gestational diabetes |

Dialogue Practice

Dialogue 1

FIRST TRIMESTER

Practice a conversation between a doctor at a walk-in clinic and a woman who has just found out she is pregnant.

- A: What brings you in today?
- B: Well, I took a home pregnancy test, and...I'm pregnant!
- A: Congratulations! When was your last period?
- B: It was about seven weeks ago.
- A: Okay. Excellent. Is this your first child?
- B: Yes.
- A: Exciting. How are you feeling? Any fatigue?
- B: I'm feeling nauseous in the mornings and tired in the afternoons.
- A: That's completely normal in your first trimester.

Sex or Gender?

The word "sex" (*noun*) refers to a person's biological characteristics (male/female). One's "gender" can refer to an individual's personal feeling about his/her/their sexuality and is not restricted to male/female.

Note: The word "sex" is also a verb meaning sexual intercourse (*to have sex*).

Dialogue 2

SECOND TRIMESTER

Now practice a conversation between an ultrasound technician and a pregnant woman.

- A: Did you drink your water?
- B: Yes. I learned my lesson last time.
- A: Good. Okay, relax. I'm going to put this gel on your belly. It's a little cold.
- B: Can we find out the baby's sex today? My husband is in the waiting room.
- A: I'll invite him in after I take some measurements. Hopefully, we'll be able to get a good look today so we can see what you're having. You're 20 weeks today, right?
- B: Yes. Halfway there!

Dialogue Practice cont.

Dialogue 3

THIRD TRIMESTER

Now practice a conversation between a midwife and a woman who has just gone into labor.

- A: Hi, it's me. I think it's time!
- B: Great! How far apart are your contractions?
- A: They're about five minutes apart now. And my water just broke.
- B: Okay. Is anyone there with you?
- A: My mom is here. Mark's on his way home.
- B: Great. Keep doing your breathing like we practiced. I'll be there in about 20 minutes.

Questions & Preparations

A. Listen & Complete

It is a good idea to prepare a list of questions before an appointment. Listen and complete the questions. Then practice saying them out loud. Add some questions of your own and check the wording with your teacher.

1. How far _____ am I?
2. How common is a _____ at this stage of gestation?
3. Will I hear the baby's _____?
4. Where can I find a local _____?
5. Will you be _____ the baby?
6. Can my partner be in the room for the _____?
7. When is my next _____?
8. Have you gotten the _____ back yet?
9. Can we find out the baby's sex at the _____ screening?
10. Should I feel any _____ in the first trimester?
11. Should I call you if I see any more _____?
12. Does amniocentesis pose a _____ to the baby or me?
13. Is this normal in the third _____?
14. When can I get an _____?
15. Will a _____ consultant be available?
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____
19. _____
20. _____

B. Brainstorm

Work in pairs. Brainstorm all of the things a pregnant woman should include in a birth plan.

- medical professional's name
- medical professional's number
- pain management plan
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Questions & Preparations cont.

C. Maria's Birth Plan

Maria is seven months pregnant. She wants to be prepared for childbirth, so she has created a birth plan. It is her second child, so she knows things might not go as planned. Her first birth ended in an emergency C-section. Read over Maria's birth plan and answer the questions.

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Maria Santiago

Mother's Name

Diego Santiago

Father's Name

March 10

Due Date

Dr. Harris

Medical Professional's Name

(204) 333-4499

Medical Professional's Phone Number

St. Mary's Hospital

Birthing Location

Planned Delivery Type:

- ☐ vaginal
☒ scheduled C-section

My Photography/Video Plan:

- ☐ photos and video of the baby and dad after delivery
☒ no photos of me in the delivery room

DURING LABOR

My birth team includes:

Dr. Harris (ob-gyn)

husband

mom

For delivery, I want to wear:

my own clothes

Pain management I may use:

- ☐ acupuncture
☐ breathing techniques
☐ heat/cold therapy
☐ massage
☐ pain medication
☒ epidural
☐ other (please specify):

If I need an emergency C-section, I want:

- ☐ to stay conscious
☐ to have my partner/coach present the baby
☐ to see the baby born
☒ other (please specify):
n/a (planned C-section)



Questions & Preparations cont.

DURING LABOR CONT.

My ideal environment includes:

- ☐ music
- ☒ dim lighting
- ☐ ability to move around
- ☒ other (please specify):
no students

During contractions, I plan to try:

- ☐ standing
- ☐ sitting
- ☐ squatting
- ☐ showering
- ☐ bathing
- ☐ lying down
- ☐ meditating
- ☐ using a ball
- ☐ using distractions
- ☒ other (please specify):
n/a (planned C-section)

It is important that my birth team knows:

I want to hold my baby as

soon as possible.

I will be hungry. Feed me!

AFTER DELIVERY

I want:

- ☒ my partner to announce the sex
- ☐ my partner to cut the cord
- ☒ to hold the baby as soon as possible
- ☐ to feed the baby as soon as possible
- ☐ to save the placenta

I want my baby to stay in the room with me:

- ☒ all the time
- ☐ when I'm not sleeping
- ☐ for feeding times mainly

I don't want my baby to:

- ☒ have a pacifier
- ☐ receive formula
- ☐ other (please specify):

I plan to:

- ☐ breast-feed
- ☐ pump breast milk
- ☒ use formula
- ☐ use a lactation consultant

If I have a boy, he will:

- ☐ be circumcised as soon as possible
- ☐ be circumcised later
- ☒ NOT be circumcised

I want to stay in the hospital:

- ☒ as long as possible
- ☐ as short as possible

Questions & Preparations cont.

D. Comprehension

Now work with a partner and answer the following questions about Maria's birth plan.

1. Who is on Maria's birth team?
2. Where does Maria plan on giving birth?
3. Is Maria planning on getting an epidural?
4. Describe Maria's ideal environment for giving birth.
5. What is one thing Maria wants her birth team to keep in mind?
6. Describe Maria's preference for sleeping arrangements after her baby is born.
7. What will Maria not do if she has a boy?
8. What are Maria's plans for feeding her baby?

Review

Your teacher will now assess your ability to understand language related to pregnancy.

Task

MY BIRTH PLAN

Complete the form with your own information. Then answer your teacher's questions.

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Mother's Name

Father's Name

Due Date

Medical Professional's Name

Medical Professional's Phone Number

Birth Location

Planned Delivery Type:

- ☐ vaginal
☐ scheduled C-section

My Photography/Video Plan:

- ☐ photos and video of the baby and dad after delivery
☐ no photos of me in the delivery room

DURING LABOR

My birth team includes:

Pain management I may use:

- ☐ acupuncture
☐ breathing techniques
☐ heat/cold therapy
☐ massage
☐ pain medication
☐ epidural
☐ other (please specify):

If I need an emergency C-section, I want:

- ☐ to stay conscious
☐ to have my partner/coach present the baby
☐ to see the baby born
☐ other (please specify):

For delivery, I want to wear:



Review cont.

Task cont.

DURING LABOR CONT.

My ideal environment includes:

- ☐ music
- ☐ dim lighting
- ☐ ability to move around
- ☐ other (please specify):

During contractions, I plan to try:

- ☐ standing
- ☐ sitting
- ☐ squatting
- ☐ showering
- ☐ bathing
- ☐ lying down
- ☐ meditating
- ☐ using a ball
- ☐ using distractions
- ☐ other (please specify):

It is important that my birth team knows:

AFTER DELIVERY

I want:

- ☐ my partner to announce the sex
- ☐ my partner to cut the cord
- ☐ to hold the baby as soon as possible
- ☐ to feed the baby as soon as possible
- ☐ to save the placenta

I want my baby to stay in the room with me:

- ☐ all the time
- ☐ when I'm not sleeping
- ☐ for feeding times mainly

I don't want my baby to:

- ☐ have a pacifier
- ☐ receive formula
- ☐ other (please specify):

I plan to:

- ☐ breast-feed
- ☐ pump breast milk
- ☐ use formula
- ☐ use a lactation consultant

If I have a boy, he will:

- ☐ be circumcised as soon as possible
- ☐ be circumcised later
- ☐ NOT be circumcised

I want to stay in the hospital:

- ☐ as long as possible
- ☐ as short as possible

Teachers' Notes

LESSON DESCRIPTION:

In this lesson, students learn vocabulary related to pregnancy and childbirth. They also create a birth plan. This lesson can be done individually with a private student or with a group. We recommend using this lesson with women who are pregnant or planning on getting pregnant.

LEVEL: High Int

TIME: 5+ hours

TAGS: pregnancy, pregnant, baby, newborn, having a baby, health, birth, birth plan, women, women's health

Warm-Up

A. CHECKLIST

Ask your students to check the medical professionals they are familiar with. Help them understand the roles (in pregnancy) of the caregivers they are not familiar with.

B. DISCUSSION

Break the class into small groups to discuss the questions (or discuss with your private student). Tell students they can search for vocabulary in Part C if necessary. When the students have completed their discussions, have them share some of their information with the class.

C. VOCABULARY PREVIEW

This is a glossary that your students can use throughout the lesson (and throughout a pregnancy). Have students read through the vocabulary and check off words they are familiar with. They can gradually add check marks to this list as they work through the lesson. You may want to encourage your students to write translations for the most important words.

Types of Appointments

A. READING

Read through the text with your students or have them read it individually. Ask students to circle or highlight any parts of the text that they have questions about. Then check their comprehension with the question set provided.

B. COMPREHENSION

1. Obstetrician-gynecologists and midwives specialize in the care of pregnant women.
2. An ob-gyn can take care of a woman in a high-risk pregnancy. A midwife can oversee a home birth or a hospital birth and also cares for the baby after the birth.
3. In a first trimester ultrasound screening, a technician will check for a heartbeat and determine the due date. The technician will also confirm if there is more than one baby developing in the womb.
4. At a test for gestational diabetes, a pregnant woman can expect to drink a very sweet drink and have a blood test.
5. A medical provider checks for growth, movement, and positioning in a third trimester checkup.
6. The term "Braxton Hicks" refers to false labor.
7. An epidural is mentioned as a specific type of pain management for strong contractions. It is only available in the hospital.
8. A family doctor and a lactation consultant may offer additional help to the mother and baby after the delivery.

(continued on the next page...)

Teachers' Notes cont.

Types of Appointments cont.

C. RESEARCH

Encourage students to complete the questionnaire about the region they currently live in. Then have them do some research in pairs to try to find answers to the information they don't know.

Vocabulary Review

A. MATCHING

- | | | | | | |
|------|------|------|------|-------|-------|
| 1. e | 3. f | 5. c | 7. a | 9. k | 11. g |
| 2. h | 4. j | 6. i | 8. b | 10. d | 12. l |

B. ODD ONE OUT

- | | | | | | |
|------|------|------|------|-------|-------|
| 1. c | 3. a | 5. b | 7. c | 9. c | 11. a |
| 2. c | 4. c | 6. c | 8. a | 10. b | 12. a |

Dialogue Practice

Have students work in pairs (or work with your private student) and read through the dialogues. Then have students switch roles. Review the (inclusive language) differences between "sex" and "gender" so that your students are aware of this modern usage.

Questions & Preparations

A. LISTEN & COMPLETE

Play the recording or read the transcript out loud. Have students fill in the blanks. Then have them practice reading the questions out loud. Go over any questions they don't understand. Then have students write five of their own questions and check their question formation.

- How far **along** am I?
- How common is a **miscarriage** at this stage of gestation?
- Will I hear the baby's **heartbeat**?
- Where can I find a local **midwife**?
- Will you be **delivering** the baby?
- Can my partner be in the room for the **screening**?
- When is my next **appointment**?
- Have you gotten the **results** back yet?
- Can we find out the baby's sex at the **ultrasound** screening?
- Should I feel any **movement** in the first trimester?
- Should I call you if I see any more **spotting**?
- Does amniocentesis pose a **risk** to the baby or me?
- Is this normal in the third **trimester**?
- When can I get an **epidural**?
- Will a **lactation** consultant be available?
- 16–20. Answers will vary.

B. BRAINSTORM

Have students brainstorm the items that should be included in a birth plan.

(continued on the next page...)

Teachers' Notes cont.

Questions & Preparations cont.

C. MARIA'S BIRTH PLAN

Put students in pairs for this task or have students work individually. Have students read through the birth plan and answer the questions. Take up the questions together to see if your students have any questions or concerns. Is there anything they would add to the birth plan?

D. COMPREHENSION

1. On Maria's birth team she has her ob-gyn, her husband, and her mom.
2. Maria plans on giving birth at St. Mary's hospital on March 10 (her scheduled C-section date).
3. Yes, Maria will have an epidural.
4. Maria would like dim lighting and no students in the room.
5. She wants to hold her baby as soon as she can.
6. Maria wants the baby to sleep in her room.
7. If she has a boy, she will not have her baby circumcised.
8. Maria plans on feeding her baby formula.

Review (Assessment Task)

If your student is pregnant or planning on becoming pregnant, hand out the blank birth plan and have your student fill it out for assessment (or real-life use). Alternatively, have your student find a template for a birth plan that she likes online and fill it out.

SPELLING NOTE:

This lesson shows the American spelling of the words *Labor*, *Color*, *Center*, *Cesarian*, and *Practice*. Most other English-speaking countries spell these words this way: *Labour*, *Colour*, *Centre*, *Caesarean*, and *Practise* (when used as a verb; *Practice* when used as a noun). Make it a challenge for your students to find these words in the lesson and see if they know the alternate spellings.